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Professional Experience

SoFi, Dallas, TX/Remote

Mar. 2024 – Present

AML Quality Assurance Senior Specialist

As an AML Quality Assurance Senior Specialist at SoFi, I work within the Quality Assurance team to thoroughly review the work product of the AML Financial Intelligence Unit (FIU) and Client Intelligence Unit (CIU) teams, ensuring compliance with internal policies and regulations. Key responsibilities include but are not limited to:

- Conducting comprehensive quality assurance reviews for AML transaction monitoring and customer due diligence processes, ensuring strict adherence to internal policies and regulatory procedures
- Analyzing and validating completed cases, ensuring thorough analysis and accurate documentation to support investigative findings
- Reviewing and assessing the disposition of adverse media alerts, confirming accurate determinations in alignment with company protocols
- Collaborating closely with the AML Team to provide feedback and implement corrective actions, enhancing overall compliance and operational efficiency
- Playing a key role in developing and implementing QA procedures and objectives, contributing to the continuous improvement of the QA function
- Identifying and assessing training needs by analyzing recurring themes in case reviews, driving targeted skill development across the team
- Performing in-depth research using various internal systems and databases in tandem with external compliance platforms and internet resources to support the resolution of complex investigations

Grant Thornton, Dallas, TX/Remote

Sept. 2021 – Feb. 2024

Senior Associate, Risk Advisory

As an AML Audit Senior Associate with Grant Thornton, I collaborated directly with team members across the organization to exercise our shared expertise and proficiency in AML practices and regulations to initiate and complete audit-based engagements for the firm's clients. My primary responsibilities in my role were to work within the engagement team to conduct thorough reviews and test the client's AML program. Further responsibilities associated with my role included, but were not limited to:

- Assisted the practice leadership in creating proposals, budgets, and work plans and participated in other business development activities as appropriate
- Contributed to and supporting client service teams on multiple AML engagements and compliance program initiatives for clients in the banking, e-commerce, crypto, blockchain, and general financial services industries.
- Participated in the creation and tracking of engagement work plans, timelines, budgets, project management, and resource allocations
- Researched, analyzed, and understood current marketplace issues and emerging regulatory requirements and guidance
- Maintained a thorough comprehension of AML typologies related to retail banking and wealth management
- Conducted Design Effectiveness Assessments (DEA) and Operating Effectiveness Testing (OET) tests during client audit engagements and documented the findings for client review.
- Managed and minimizing engagement risk by proactively identifying issues and recommended courses of remediation
- Managed, developed, trained, and mentored staff on projects and assessing performance for engagement and year-end reviews
- Maintained active communication with clients to manage expectations, ensure satisfaction, and become a trusted business partner
- Attended professional development and networking events and training seminars on a regular basis
- Adhered to the highest degree of professional standards and strict client confidentiality

eBay, Dallas, TX/Remote

Nov. 2020 – Sept. 2021

Sr. Business Analyst – Contractor

As a Sr. Business Analyst with eBay, I collaborated directly with teams across the organization to gather and employ our combined knowledge and expertise in the development and launch of the In-House AML KYC case management system. My primary responsibilities in my role were to actively communicate needs and/or challenges observed, while also assessing the platform to ensure the best possible product rollout. Further responsibilities associated with my role included, but were not limited to:

- Worked with various AML, operations, engineering, and product teams to define and document the In-House system requirements using interviews, analysis, and documentation
- Conducted User Access Testing (UAT) prior to the launch of new or updated systems to validate that they are performing according to the required real-life scenarios
- Use of Agile product development methodologies and practices
- Tracked regulatory developments in the crypto and digital assets space, updating internal policies and training materials to maintain program alignment with industry expectations
- Lead quarterly Quality Assurance (QA) reviews to evaluate and improve the compliance of the existing In-House KYC case management system and the associated operating procedures
- Collaborated with colleagues across multiple time zones and regions to drive operational consistency and efficiency, while demonstrating adaptability and strong communication skills
- Researched legislation for the current and prospective jurisdictions to assist in meeting or exceeding the associated AML compliance requirements
- Provided thought leadership to lead the design and development of a global AML KYC case management application
- Drafted detailed investigative summaries and risk assessments, presenting concise recommendations on onboarding, ongoing monitoring, or off boarding based on policy threshold
- Coordinated with product, engineering, and legal teams to optimize KYC systems and define requirements for onboarding tools and workflows, ensuring they meet regulatory standards and improve user experience
- Owned, documented, and drove business requirements on behalf of AML and Compliance operations teams across the globe
- Applied in-depth AML knowledge to develop new functionalities that help prevent, mitigate, or manage AML risk
- Utilized strong analytical skills to understand, document, and prioritize solutions for complex business problems regarding AML and KYC processes
- Managed multiple stakeholders' expectations and delivered a live functional product under tight deadlines

Citigroup, Dallas, TX/Remote

Jan. 2020 – Oct. 2020

AML Compliance Specialist – Contractor

As an AML Compliance Specialist, I worked as a member of the Citigroup team to utilize my enhanced understanding when identifying and reviewing the potential AML risks associated with alerted accounts. My primary responsibilities were to conduct research over available systems, the Internet, and commercial databases consistent with the resolution of case reviews and investigation. Further responsibilities associated with my role included, but were not limited to:

- The completion of 5 Enhanced Due Diligence (EDD) reviews weekly with the intent of identifying and documenting suspicious activities in subsequent SAR reporting to the Financial Crimes Enforcement Network (FinCEN)
- To collect and examine the financial statements and documents to assist in identifying unusual transaction patterns
- Applied knowledge of laws associated with money laundering, including the Bank Secrecy Act, the USA PATRIOT act, US Treasury AML guidelines, Electronic Funds Transfer Act, OFAC requirements, and Suspicious Activity Reporting
- Conducted follow-ups with additional Point(s) of Contact (POC) as needed to identify additional information in support of the case investigations and escalations
- Assessed customer profiles and client data to determine that actions were consistent with expected activity, including the Acceptable Use Policy adherence and Know Your Customer efforts
- Conducted Continuing Activity Reviews based on previously SARs filed and determine whether a subsequent filing is appropriate based on facts and circumstances
- Conducted investigations related to 314(a) matches, 314(b) requests and law enforcement inquiries as necessary
- Issued recommendations to Senior Management regarding relationship retention or termination and tracking account closures as required
- Worked with a team of six analysts to test the effectiveness of possible case investigation and review procedures prior to their implementation across the Financial Intelligence Unit (FIU)

Navigant, Dallas, TX

Aug. 2019 – Dec. 2019

Project Consultant – Global Investigations and Compliance – AML – Contractor

As an AML Project Consultant, I worked with the Navigant team to bring the compilation of my knowledge and experience to the unique global investigations and compliance services they offer to their diverse portfolio of clients. My primary responsibilities were to function as a tenured quality control analyst, alert and case investigator, and PEP subject matter expert. Further responsibilities associated with my role included, but were not limited to:

- Completed 100-120 Quality Control (QC) reviews weekly through pool of finalized cases and alerts to determine the legitimacy of the analysts' dispositions
- Conducted assessments of analysts' work product to provide necessary coaching and feedback to further ensure quality decision making and reviews
- Applied investigative techniques to complex information sets to make logical and effectively supported recommendations on cases for reporting to the Financial Crimes Enforcement Network (FinCEN)
- Reviewed 500 Actimize alerts weekly to determine if the client's customer was properly designated as a PEP or as a direct associate of a PEP
- Completed 40 meticulous analytical reviews weekly of potentially suspicious activity related to customers across multiple jurisdictions and countries
- Assessed customer profiles and client data to determine that actions were consistent with expected activity, including the Acceptable Use Policy adherence and Know Your Customer efforts

Capital One, Plano, TX

Aug. 2018 – Jul. 2019

AML Senior Investigator II – Contractor

As an AML Senior Investigator II, I further expanded my knowledge of anti-money laundering and regulatory compliance. My primary responsibilities were to review suspicious activity associated with alerts triggered in the system while assisting analysts improve and strengthen their investigative prowess. These processes were integral to the proper dispositioning of the alerts triggered in the Actimize Case Management System and the Suspicious Activity Reports (SARs) that were filed daily. The range of my responsibilities was essential to developing and maintaining an array of effective procedures that demonstrated the qualitative nature of my reviews. My contributions as an investigator were as follows:

- Built and maintained awareness of the broader context and implications of the diverse types of risk affecting the business (e.g., financial, legal, reputation, etc.)
- Reviewed and dispositioned 40 system generated alerts per week, assessed the impact to the AML processes, conducted extensive Know Your Customer (KYC) and Enhanced Due Diligence (EDD) reviews, and collected and documented additional research as needed
- Wrote and filed SARs, audited, and filed Currency Transaction Reports (CTRs), addressed sanctions alerts, and other applicable AML processes in accordance with regulations and time limitations
- Conducted research utilizing available systems, databases, and the internet, consistent with the resolution of AML transaction monitoring investigations
- Reviewed relevant income and employment documentation to assist in determining that the detected activity was within the expected customer profile
- Employed knowledge of Bank Secrecy Act, Anti-Money Laundering, OFAC, USA PATRIOT Act, OFAC and other AML regulatory policies.
- Utilized Due Diligence, Negative News and Boolean searches, and additional investigative practices to identify typologies, patterns, and/or activity that may coincide with potential sanctions, peer-to-peer payments, credit card fraud, ACH fraud, money laundering, terrorist financing, or otherwise suspicious activity
- Provided feedback on alert rule effectiveness and partnering with management and analysts to design new rules
- Supported team supervisors in execution of certain responsibilities (e.g., reviewing completed files, providing feedback, etc.)

AML Compliance Analyst II

Upon noteworthy performance and growth, I was promoted to the role of AML Compliance Analyst II. In addition to my duties in my previous role, I took on additional responsibilities. My application of logic, reasoning, and sound decision-making provided me insight to better recommend and execute over 3,000 SAR filings. I conducted over 200 individual Quality Assurance (QA) reviews for incoming case analysts to ensure the quality and production standards were both met and surpassed. The extent of my knowledge and experience expanded to identifying and researching patterns, trends, and anomalies in complex transactional customer data, which allowed me to detect, report, and assist in preventing potential suspicious activity as it related to alert typologies. I ensured that my work product and output exceeded the quality and production expectations of our Money Services Business (MSB) client, while contributing to the development of individual and project goals of our firm. My responsibilities were as follows:

- Conducted complex case investigations, performing Customer Due Diligence (CDD) reviews, and drafting Suspicious Activity Reports (SARs)
- Analyzed 45 to 60 account transaction histories weekly to identify potential money laundering typologies and other unusual or potentially suspicious behavior
- Performed in-depth investigations on potential suspicious activity to determine whether it qualifies as illegitimate or illicit
- Completed thorough due diligence research and negative news screenings using client systems, internet searches, LexisNexis, and other due diligence tools to determine whether AML risks or red flags exist
- Reviewed, analyzed, and organized data to write comprehensive supporting investigative narratives and SAR to the benefit of law enforcement
- Facilitated 50 individual and group training sessions annually to assist in the development of new analysts

AML Compliance Analyst I

Due to my affinity for quality and my natural orientation to detail, I made a transition into the financial services sector as an AML Compliance Analyst I. The role of the compliance analyst is essential to any company, as it relates to checks and balances, ethics, and overall company efficacy. My primary responsibility was to identify potentially suspicious activity within the clients' system through triggered alerts and escalated investigations. Within my research process, my ability to thoroughly review, analyze, and organize data helped me to determine whether AML risks were present and how to address them. My range of daily tasks were essential to maintaining a superior level of quality and work product. My contributions as an analyst included:

- Examined complex alerts and other data to write comprehensive supporting investigative narratives and Suspicious Activity Reports (SARs) to the benefit of law enforcement
- Analyzed 20 to 35 account transaction histories weekly to identify potential money laundering typologies and other unusual or suspicious behavior

Education & Certifications:

Miami University: College of Arts and Sciences – Oxford, OH - B.A. in Sociology
ACAMS – Certified Anti-Money Laundering Specialist
ACFE – Certified Fraud Examiner

May. 2014
Nov. 2019
Dec. 2019

Case Management Systems:

NICE Actimize, SAS Enterprise Case Management, and Verafin